Squid reactions

☞ **1** Order the following sentences about scientists studying the central nervous system of the squid, then rewrite the paragraph below.

Thanks to the humble squid, scientists since the 1930s have been able to study in detail how nerves work.

It is about 1 mm in diameter and almost a metre long.

These experiments earned scientists a Nobel Prize in 1963 and form the basis of our understanding of nerve cells today.

Because the nerve is so long, scientists could place **electrodes** inside it to measure changes in current flow across the cell membranes when a nerve fired.

Human nerves are very thin and hard to see, but the squid has the longest nerve of any known creature.

Squid are invertebrates that have a highly developed **sensory** and nervous system.

This nerve is called the giant axon and it is involved in **propelling** the squid through the water quickly.

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2 Write whether the following statements are true or false.

a) The giant axon is the largest known nerve. _____

b) The axon is involved in squid vision. _____

c) Human nerves are so thin they are hard to see. _____

d) An electric current could be measured in the axon. _____

e) Humans have a nerve called the giant axon. _____

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ISBN 978 1 92571 041 0